

**Question:**  
At birth, the least developed part of the brain is the

Answer Choices:

- A. visual system
- B. thalamus
- C. frontal lobe
- D. brain stem
- E. parietal lobe
- F. cerebellum
- G. cortex
- H. basal ganglia
- I. hypothalamus
- J. limbic system

**Reasoning + Answer:**

<think>

Concise explanation :

- The cerebral cortex develops late in fetal and early postnatal life compared to deeper brain structures . It has a complex sequence of maturation and differentiation : neurons proliferate , migrate , integrate , and mature with their myelinated axons . This development typically peaks around 2-3 years and is incomplete at birth .

- By contrast , the brain stem and diencephalon ( including thalamus and hypothalamus ) are much more mature at birth . The cerebellum , basal ganglia , and limbic system also start early and are relatively well-developed at birth .

- The visual system ( retinal ganglion cells and optic nerve ) starts to function in utero , but the developing cortical regions that receive visual input ( e.g ., V1 , V2 ) are especially immature at birth .

Correct answer : G . cortex

</think>

<answer>

G . cortex

</answer>

